The Jammed Jar

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 3, Episode 2

At the supply shelter, tiny fixing pieces rested inside a clean reused jar. Its lid was jammed. Nib twisted until the whole jar turned in his paws. Lark put a padded tray beneath it before the little fittings could be tipped onto the floor.

“A jar with a very firm opinion,” Nib muttered suspiciously. “Let us give it a gentler suggestion,” Lark urged.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **see**

“Lowercase j begins jam and job,” Lark modeled clearly. “Make its one quick voiced sound, /j/, without an extra vowel. Join j, a, m for jam. The word can describe what is happening here even though this jar holds fittings rather than a picnic spread.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try jam, jet, jog, job. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read the short job label,” Lark invited gently. “Then use the supplied diagram to choose pressing and lifting instead of tipping.”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **Sam can jog. Pat can get jam.**

“Who can get jam?” Lark asked warmly. “Which friend has the different job?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

The jar rested in the tray's padded recess. Nib pressed the stiff catch and lifted the lid while Lark held the tray steady. No little pieces spilled. They sorted the fittings into separate shallow spaces and closed the tray. A larger glass pane still waited nearby; that load needed a wheeled carrier rather than a mouse carrying everything at once.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write j beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal showed the jar sitting safely in its recess. Outside the shelter stood a small woodland delivery van with space for a padded load. The fittings were ready to travel with the glass.